World survey – the Aegean and the ancient Western Mediterranean: ancient texts for Hebrew translation

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Prepared 2026-10-21 for `שונות/תרגומי-טקסטים-קדומים/`. Part of the world survey (one file per region).
Region: Mycenaean Greek (Linear B); Archaic Greek (to c. 450 BCE, plus later texts that keep old tradition); Etruscan; Old Latin and the other Italic languages; Iberian/Celtiberian briefly.
Legend: **verified** = fetched today (2026-10-21) from this session, expected content seen; **reported** = from search results or my own knowledge, not fetched. Bible benefit and Soul benefit are each rated HIGH / MED-HIGH / MEDIUM / LOW.
Cross-references to other regions: the Hittite Kumarbi cycle (Anatolia), Philo of Byblos / Sanchuniathon and the Phoenician side of the Pyrgi tablets (Levant), Gaulish (Celtic Europe) belong to sibling surveys; they are named here only where a text of this region depends on them.

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0. Key findings

1. **Hesiod (Theogony 1,022 lines + Works and Days 828 lines) is the best candidate of the region, and one of the best of the world survey.** It is a complete, small, well-preserved corpus, c. 700 BCE, and the Greek text that is closest to the Near East. Its parallels hit the commentary's own priorities:
   - **Gen 1**: Chaos first (Th. 116), Night and then Day born from it (Th. 123–124 ↔ "evening and morning", 1:5), the separation of Sky from Earth;
   - **the fifth day, now in progress**: Keto and the sea monsters (Th. 238, 270–336). The LXX renders *tanninim* in Gen 1:21 as κήτη, the same root. Typhoeus has "a hundred heads of a snake, a dread δράκων" with fire from his eyes (Th. 825–828, verified) ↔ Leviathan (Job 41:10–13; Isa 27:1, where the LXX has δράκων);
   - **Gen 2–3**: Pandora shaped from earth; "before, the tribes of men lived on earth apart from evils, without hard toil" (WD 90–92, verified) ↔ 3:16–19. WD 289 "before excellence the gods have set sweat" ↔ 3:19 *be-zeʿat appekha*;
   - **Gen 6:1–4**: the race of *hēmitheoi*, "demigods" (WD 159–160, verified);
   - **Gen 8:20–21**: the sacrifice at Mekone (Th. 535–616), which founds sacrifice and the divide between gods and men after a crisis;
   - **Lev 26 and Deut 28**: the just and the unjust city (WD 225–247);
   - **Lev 23 and Gen 2:3**: "the seventh, a holy day" (WD 770, verified);
   - **Prov 27:10**: the neighbour and the kinsman (WD 342–346).

   The base text is open and **word-by-word lemmatized and parsed**: the Perseus Treebank covers Theogony, Works and Days and the Shield (verified).

2. **The Homeric epics have a clean open base text** (Iliad 15,687 lines, Monro–Allen 1920; Odyssey 12,107 lines; both verified on Perseus, both treebanked). But a full new Hebrew Homer is not worth it: Tchernichovsky's translation is public domain and online (verified on Ben-Yehuda), and Shabtai's is from 2014–2016. **A selection with an apparatus is worth it.** Strongest passages:
   - **Iliad 11.27–28**, rainbows "which Kronion set in the cloud, a sign for mortal men" (verified) ↔ **Gen 9:13**, "my bow I have set in the cloud, and it shall be for a sign". Gen 8:20–11:26 has no commentary yet.
   - **Odyssey 11.305–320**: the giants Otus and Ephialtes, sons of a god by a mortal woman, nine fathoms tall, pile Ossa on Olympus and Pelion on Ossa "so that heaven might be scaled" (verified) ↔ Gen 6:4 and Gen 11:4 in one passage.
   - Iliad 14.201, 246: Ocean as the "origin (γένεσις) of gods" and of all things ↔ Gen 1:2.
   - Iliad 15.187–193: the cosmos divided by lot ↔ Atraḫasis, and Deut 32:8–9.
   - Iliad 1: Apollo Smintheus ("of the mice") and the plague ↔ 1 Sam 5–6.
   - Iliad 6: the leaves (6.146–149) ↔ Isa 40:6–8 and Sir 14:18; Bellerophon's letter ↔ 2 Sam 11:14–15.
   - Iliad 23.141–153: hair cut for the dead ↔ Lev 19:27–28 and Deut 14:1.
   - Iliad 24.527–533: the two jars of Zeus ↔ Job 2:10.
   - Odyssey 11.489–491: Achilles would rather be a hired hand alive than king of the dead ↔ Qoh 9:4.
3. **The best law and ritual comparanda of the region have NO Hebrew translation at all**, so the gain per line is high:
   - the **Gortyn Code** (c. 480–450 BCE, 12 columns, about 600 lines): the heiress (*patroiōkos*) ↔ the daughters of Zelophehad (Num 27, 36); rape and seduction ↔ Deut 22:23–29 and Ex 22:15–16; slaves, divorce and adoption;
   - **Draco's homicide law** (621/0, recut 409/8 BCE; IG I³ 104) ↔ Num 35 and Deut 19, unintentional homicide, exile and the kin's pardon;
   - the **Selinous lex sacra** (c. 475–450): purification from avenging spirits after bloodshed;
   - the **Cyrene cathartic law**: "Apollo declared..."; birth, death and sex impurity ↔ Lev 12, 15 and Num 19. Its open EpiDoc Greek text was verified on IGCyr (CC BY-NC 4.0);
   - the **Teos public curses** ↔ Deut 27:15–26.

   The access problem: PHI Greek Inscriptions (403) and CGRN (connection refused) are blocked here, and no open digital Greek text of Gortyn was found.
4. **A surprise for the project's own method: the Derveni papyrus** (roll c. 340–320 BCE, text c. 420–400 BCE). It is the oldest European literary manuscript and the **oldest surviving word-by-word allegorical commentary on a sacred poem**. The commentator quotes an Orphic theogony lemma by lemma and asks why the poet used each word. That is exactly the method of the `/פירוש`. It is a historical mirror for the commentary itself, besides being an Orphic Gen 1 analogue: Night, Ouranos, Kronos, and Zeus swallowing the first-born and recreating the world. The Greek text is online at CHS (verified page) but it is © Olschki 2006: it can be consulted, not committed.
5. **Old Latin and the Roman archaic formulae make a compact corpus with strong Torah links.** It is well resourced and its texts are open (verified):
   - the **Twelve Tables** (451–450 BCE): "si membrum rupsit, ni cum eo pacit, talio esto" (VIII.2, verified on The Latin Library) ↔ Ex 21:23–25; the night thief ↔ Ex 22:1–2;
   - the **Carmen Arvale**;
   - **Cato's farm prayers** (the suovetaurilia lustration of the fields, verified on LacusCurtius: Goetz/Loeb 1934, public domain) ↔ Lev 1–3;
   - the **fetial oath** in which a pig is struck with a flint, "so strike the Roman people" (Livy 1.24) ↔ Gen 15 and Jer 34:18;
   - the **devotio** ↔ *ḥerem*.
6. **The Umbrian Iguvine Tables** (seven bronzes, c. 200–70 BCE; c. 4,500 words; the longest ritual text of ancient Italy) are a real Leviticus analogue: lustration of the citadel and the people, sacrifices at three gates, bird-augury, expulsion of foreigners. Umbrian is only **partly** understood. Poultney's 1959 edition and translation is **out of copyright and full-view on archive.org** (verified: University of Florida "copyright status reviewed – out of copyright"). Buck 1904 (public domain, verified) prints the text in usable OCR, because the script is Latin.
7. **Etruscan is still poorly understood.** The grammar is reasonably known, but the reliable vocabulary is a few hundred words. The long texts (Liber Linteus about 1,200 legible words; Tabula Capuana about 390) can be translated only in part, so an LLM translation would be guesswork. **Only the Pyrgi gold tablets** (c. 500 BCE, Etruscan–Phoenician paraphrase) and the **Piacenza liver** (god-names on a sheep's liver model ↔ Babylonian liver models, the Hazor clay livers and Ezek 21:26) are worth a small, heavily hedged dossier. Iberian is read but not understood: exclude it. Celtiberian (Botorrita) is too thin.
8. **Linear B** is well deciphered Greek, but it is palace bookkeeping. A small dossier of the **religious tablets** has an honest, modest value: PY Tn 316, the Un 718 offerings to Poseidon (wheat, wine, a bull, cheese, honey ↔ Lev 2:11, where honey is banned), KN Fp oil by months ↔ Num 28–29, and Chania Gq 5 with Dionysus. The genre parallel is the offering lists of Num 7. The main open corpus, **DAMOS (Oslo), is blocked from this session**. Ventris–Chadwick is copyrighted, and the archive.org "uploads" of it are unauthorized: avoid them.
9. **Access facts:**
   - `raw.githubusercontent.com` works, and so does a **treeless `git clone` of public GitHub repos** (used today for PerseusDL `canonical-greekLit` with 2,541 XML files, `canonical-latinLit`, `treebank_data`, and OGL `First1KGreek` with 1,022 Greek files). The github.com web pages and the API are session-gated (403).
   - LSJ is reachable per word through the **Logeion API** (`anastrophe.uchicago.edu`, verified). The Perseus "hopper" dynamic pages answer 405.
   - archive.org works, but its **Greek OCR is garbage**: Kern's *Orphicorum fragmenta* came out as Latin letters, verified. Greek base texts must therefore come from Perseus, First1KGreek or IGCyr XML, not from page scans.
   - First1KGreek has Diels' *Orphica* fragments (DK 1), including the Petelia/Thurii gold tablets (verified, CC BY-SA). It does **not** have the Presocratics in general.

10. **Existing Hebrew translations, and what a new one adds:**
    - **Homer**: Tchernichovsky (Iliad 1930, Odyssey 1930s–1942; public domain; on Ben-Yehuda, verified); Kahana, Odyssey (Keter 1996); Aroeti, Iliad and Odyssey in prose (Magnes 2012; Iliad 2nd ed. 2016, verified); Shabtai, Odyssey (Schocken 2014) and Iliad (Schocken 2016).
    - **Hesiod**: Spann (Mossad Bialik 1956, all three poems); Shabtai, Works and Days (Schocken 2004); Bouzaglo, Theogony (Even Hoshen 2017).
    - **Homeric Hymns**: Spann (1946).
    - **Sappho**: Bouzaglo (Even Hoshen 2009); Liebes (essays with translations, online).
    - **Lyric**: Shabtai's anthology (2023) *שירת יוון העתיקה*.
    - **Herodotus**: Schorr (1935–36), Shimron and Zelnick-Abramovitz (1998).
    - **None found** for the Derveni papyrus, the gold tablets, Gortyn, the sacred laws, Linear B, Etruscan, Umbrian, or (so far) the Presocratics and the Twelve Tables.
    - **What a new one adds:** no existing Hebrew Homer or Hesiod has a line-by-line apparatus of Near Eastern and biblical parallels. That apparatus, not a new literary version, is the gain.

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1. Ranked shortlist

#	Text	Language · date (composition / oral) · earliest ms	Size · condition	Bible focus (verses)	Soul focus	Bible / Soul benefit	Base text (open?)	Feasibility
1	**Hesiod, Theogony + Works and Days** (+ Shield optional)	Epic Greek · c. 730–680 BCE (oral-traditional, fixed in writing c. 700) · papyri from the Hellenistic/Roman period, medieval mss (verify earliest)	1,022 + 828 lines (+ Shield 480) · complete	Gen 1:1–5 (Chaos, Night→Day), 1:6–8, **1:21** (Keto/κήτη; Typhoeus ↔ Leviathan), 2:7, 2:22, 3:16–19, 4:3–5, **6:1–4**, 8:20–21, 11; Lev 26/Deut 28 (WD 225–247); Gen 2:3 (WD 770); Prov; Amos 5:8	cosmogony, theodicy, labour, justice, a farmer's year, the first poet's "I"	**HIGH / HIGH**	Perseus (Evelyn-White 1914, public domain; CC BY-SA markup) + treebank, **verified**	Excellent. Greek is well resourced; full lemma/morph data
2	**Homer, a selection**: Il. 1, 6, 11.1–46, 14.153–360, 15.184–199, 23.1–257, 24; Od. 11 (+ 12 Thrinacia)	Epic Greek · Iliad c. 750–680, Odyssey c. 725–650 (oral tradition back to the Mycenaean age) · papyri 3rd c. BCE; Venetus A, 10th c.	≈ 3,800 lines in all · complete	**Gen 9:13** (Il. 11.27–28, 17.547–549), **Gen 6:4 + 11:4** (Od. 11.305–320), Gen 1:2 (Il. 14.201, 246), Deut 32:8 (Il. 15.187–193), Lev 1–3 (Il. 1.447–474), Lev 19:27–28 (Il. 23), 1 Sam 5–6, 28; Job 2:10; Qoh 9:4; Isa 40:6–8; 2 Sam 11	mourning, ransom, pity of enemy for enemy, the dead	**MED-HIGH / HIGH**	Perseus (Monro–Allen 1920; Murray 1919), public domain + treebank, **verified**	Excellent. The question is the value added over Tchernichovsky and Shabtai
3	**Archaic Greek laws and sacred laws**: Gortyn Code + Dreros + Draco + Selinous lex sacra + Cyrene cathartic law + Teos Dirae (+ selected CGRN)	Doric/Attic/Ionic epigraphic Greek · 650–300 BCE (inscriptions are the originals)	≈ 1,000 lines in all · Gortyn excellent; Draco damaged; Selinous fair	**Ex 21–23**, **Num 27/36**, **Num 35 / Deut 19**, Deut 22:13–29, **Lev 12, 15**, Num 19, **Deut 27:15–26**	how a polis judged, purified, cursed	**HIGH / MED-HIGH**	IGCyr EpiDoc **verified** (CC BY-NC); Gortyn: no open digital Greek found (PHI 403); Draco/Teos: older public-domain corpora	Medium. Dialect and damage are manageable; the base text must be keyed from editions

#	Text	Language · date (composition / oral) · earliest ms	Size · condition	Bible focus (verses)	Soul focus	Bible / Soul benefit	Base text (open?)	Feasibility
4	**Hesiodic Catalogue of Women + cosmogonic Epic Cycle fragments** (Cypria fr. 1)	Epic Greek · c. 580–520 BCE (West) or 7th c. · papyri 1st–3rd c. CE + quotations	≈ 1,000+ partial lines · fragmentary	**Gen 6:1–4** (fr. 1; fr. 204.95–123 M-W, the end of the demigods), **Gen 10** (Hellen → Dorus, Xuthus → Ion ↔ Javan; eponym genealogies), Gen 6:5–7 (Cypria fr. 1: Earth burdened by too many men), Deucalion ↔ Gen 6–9	heroines, genealogy as history	**HIGH / MEDIUM**	Modern editions © (Merkelbach–West 1967, Most 2018); Evelyn-White 1914 and Rzach 1913 (public domain, fewer papyri)	Medium-low. Damage, plus a copyrighted best text
5	**Homeric Hymns** (Demeter, Apollo, Hermes, Aphrodite + 29 short)	Epic Greek · c. 680–480 BCE · Demeter only in one ms (Leiden, 14th–15th c.)	2,342 lines (verified count) · good	Ps 29/Ex 15 (Apollo and the she-dragon at Pytho ↔ Gen 1:21); Gen 3:22 (Demophon's failed immortality in the fire); Gen 18 (gods as disguised guests)	a mother's grief, mysteries, a trickster child	**MEDIUM / HIGH**	Perseus (Evelyn-White 1914), public domain; Demeter treebanked, **verified**	Excellent
6	**Orphic corpus: Derveni papyrus + gold tablets**	Greek · poem c. 500 BCE?; commentary c. 420–400; roll c. 340–320; tablets c. 400 BCE–3rd c. CE	26 columns (tops only) + about 40 short texts · damaged / good	Gen 1 (a cosmogony by speech? "Zeus head, Zeus middle"), Gen 2–3 (the spring and the white cypress; "child of Earth and starry Heaven"); **method of the commentary**	death and salvation, initiation, allegory	**MEDIUM / HIGH**	Derveni: CHS online (© Olschki); tablets: First1KGreek Diels (CC BY-SA) **verified** + Tzifopoulos 2010 (CHS, CC)	Medium. Copyright on Derveni; damage

#	Text	Language · date (composition / oral) · earliest ms	Size · condition	Bible focus (verses)	Soul focus	Bible / Soul benefit	Base text (open?)	Feasibility
7	**Roman archaic law and ritual corpus**: Twelve Tables, Carmen Arvale, Cato's prayers and charms (DAC 83, 132, 134, 139–141, 160), fetial / devotio / evocatio formulae, Lapis Niger, Duenos, Lex Spoletina, SC de Bacchanalibus, Scipionic epitaphs	Old Latin · 6th–2nd c. BCE (songs older) · inscriptions; quotations 1st c. BCE+	≈ 600–800 lines · Twelve Tables reconstructed from quotations	**Ex 21–23** (talio, night thief, Ex 22:17 *malum carmen*), Gen 15 / Jer 34:18 (fetial oath), Lev 1–3, Num 19, Deut 13 (Bacchanalia), Deut 20 / Josh 6–7 (devotio/evocatio ↔ *ḥerem*), Deut 16:21 (sacred grove law)	the Roman farmer's fear and piety, epitaphs	**MED-HIGH / MED-HIGH**	Latin Library, LacusCurtius **verified**; CIL I² and Bruns (public domain)	Good. Latin is well resourced; archaic forms are manageable
8	**Archaic lyric and elegy**: Archilochus, Sappho, Alcaeus, Alcman (Partheneion + cosmogony), Tyrtaeus, Solon, Mimnermus, Semonides 7, Theognidea	Lesbian/Ionic/Doric Greek · 680–480 BCE · papyri 3rd c. BCE–3rd c. CE; Theognis medieval	Theognidea about 1,400 lines; the rest fragments · mixed	Ps 90:10 (Solon fr. 27, ten hebdomads = 70 years), Qoh 4:2–3 and Job 3 (Theognis 425–428: "best never to be born"), Qoh 12 (Mimnermus), Gen 2–3 / Prov 31 (Semonides 7), Gen 1 (Alcman's Poros/Tekmor)	love, war, exile, age, drinking songs	**MEDIUM / HIGH**	Modern editions © (West IEG², Voigt, PMGF); public domain: Bergk PLG⁴, Edmonds 1922–27	Medium. Copyright; many Hebrew versions exist (Sappho)
9	**Umbrian Iguvine Tables**	Umbrian · ritual older; bronzes c. 200–70 BCE (Umbrian and Latin scripts)	about 4,500 words, 7 tablets · well preserved	**Lev 1–16** (pre-sacrifice purity, colour of victims, fat and offal, lustration of the people), Lev 16 (expulsion), Deut 18:10 (augury)	a priestly brotherhood's whole year	**MEDIUM / HIGH**	Poultney 1959 (full view, out of copyright) **verified**; Buck 1904, Bréal 1875 (public domain)	Medium-low. The language is partly obscure; LLM risk high in places

#	Text	Language · date (composition / oral) · earliest ms	Size · condition	Bible focus (verses)	Soul focus	Bible / Soul benefit	Base text (open?)	Feasibility
10	**Presocratic cosmogonies**: Pherecydes of Syros, Anaximander (incl. the fish-origin of humans), Xenophanes, Heraclitus, Parmenides' proem, Empedocles (incl. the Strasbourg papyrus)	Ionic/epic Greek · 6th–5th c. BCE · quotations in later authors; Strasbourg papyrus 1st c. CE	a few hundred fragments · indirect tradition	Gen 1:2, **1:20–23** (Anaximander DK 12 A30: the first humans born inside fish; Empedocles' zoogony), Gen 3 serpent (Pherecydes' Ophioneus ↔ Leviathan), Deut 4:15–19 / Isa 40 (Xenophanes on images of gods)	the birth of rational cosmology	**MEDIUM / HIGH**	Diels 1903–22 (public domain scans, Greek OCR unusable); Laks–Most 2016 ©	Medium. Base must be keyed; DK numbering
11	**Greek curse tablets and archaic verse inscriptions** (Nestor's cup, Dipylon jug, Mantiklos, Phrasikleia; the earliest *defixiones*)	Greek · 740–400 BCE (originals)	small items, a corpus of about 100 · mixed	Num 5:21–27 (written curse), Ps 109, Zech 5:1–4, Deut 27	erotic jokes, a girl dead before marriage, revenge	**MEDIUM / HIGH**	DTA (Wünsch 1897), Audollent 1904 (public domain scans); CEG ©	Medium
12	**Linear B religious tablets** (selection)	Mycenaean Greek · KN c. 1400–1350, PY c. 1200–1180 BCE (originals)	about 50 tablets · good (fire-baked)	Num 7 and 28–29 (offering lists), Lev 2:11 (honey), Ex 30 (perfumed oil), Gen 47:22 (temple land; PY Ep 704 priestess' lawsuit)	the palace and its gods, the eve of collapse (PY An 657 "watchers guarding the coast")	**LOW-MED / MEDIUM**	DAMOS (open, **blocked here**); Ventris–Chadwick ©	Medium. Ideograms; uncertain words
13	**Etruscan dossier**: Pyrgi tablets, Piacenza liver, Tabula Capuana (excerpt), Liber Linteus (excerpt)	Etruscan · c. 500 BCE (Pyrgi), 470 (Capua), 3rd–2nd c. (linen book), c. 100 (liver)	Pyrgi 16+9 lines; liver about 40 names · good / damaged	Ezek 21:26 (hepatoscopy); Pyrgi's Phoenician "burial of the deity" ↔ Ezek 8:14 (debated)	ritual calendar, how a lost people prayed	**LOW-MED / MEDIUM**	no open critical edition (ET² © 2014); Lehmann's Pyrgi page **verified**	**Low.** The language is poorly understood
14	**Herodotus 1–2 (selected)**	Ionic prose · c. 430 BCE · papyri; medieval mss	Book 2 about 180 chapters · complete	reception: 2.104 (circumcision of the "Syrians of Palestine"), 2.159 (Necho at Magdolos), 1.178–200 (Babylon); Gen 41–47 (Egypt)	the first ethnographer	**MEDIUM / MEDIUM**	Perseus (Godley), CC BY-SA, **verified**; treebank Book 1	Easy, but two Hebrew translations exist. Low priority

2. The survey

2.1 Hesiod, *Theogony* and *Works and Days* (and the *Shield*)

Epic (Ionic-Aeolic, with Boeotian colour) Greek · composition c. 730–680 BCE (West: the Theogony slightly before the WD; dated by linguistic and historical criteria and the relation to Homer; fairly sure to ±50 years) · oral-traditional diction, but a single poet with a named persona (Th. 22–34; WD 27–41, 633–662) · earliest witnesses: papyrus fragments of the Ptolemaic and Roman periods, and complete medieval manuscripts (verify the earliest; the WD has a scholia tradition) · Th. 1,022 lines, WD 828, Shield 480 (verified counts of Perseus `<l n>`; Perseus has 1,042 `<l>` tags in the Theogony, including bracketed lines) · preservation: complete; debated interpolations (e.g., Th. 901–1022 "continuation"; the Typhoeus episode 820–880 is sometimes suspected but defended by West).

- *What it is.* In the **Theogony**, the Muses meet the shepherd Hesiod under Helicon and make him a singer; they "know how to say many false things like true ones, and when they wish, to utter true things" (27–28, verified).
  - He then sings the birth of the world: Chaos (the "gap"), Earth, Tartarus, Eros; Night and Erebos; Day from Night.
  - Then come the generations of the gods: Ouranos is castrated by Kronos; Kronos swallows his children and is given a stone; Zeus is born in Crete.
  - Then the Titanomachy, and the monster Typhoeus defeated by Zeus' thunder.
  - Zeus swallows Metis and becomes the final king; Prometheus tricks Zeus at the sacrifice of Mekone; the first woman is made.

  In the **Works and Days**, a farmer–poet rebukes his brother Perses over a lawsuit and bribe-eating "kings".
  - He tells Prometheus and Pandora (the jar of evils, Hope left inside), the five races of men (gold, silver, bronze, heroes, iron), and the fable of the hawk and the nightingale.
  - He preaches justice and work; then comes a farmer's and sailor's year by the stars (the Pleiades, Orion, Sirius) and lucky and unlucky days of the month.

- *Bible parallels.* The consensus that Hesiod's succession myth has Near Eastern antecedents is **accepted** (Kumarbi, Enūma eliš; West 1966, 1997; Burkert 1992). Direct biblical contact is **debated**: most see shared Levantine and Anatolian tradition, not dependence. Specific points:
  - **Gen 1:1–5**: πρώτιστα Χάος γένετ' (116, verified), "first of all Chaos came to be". Then Night bears Aither and Day (123–124, verified): the Hebrew order "evening, then morning" ↔ Night first, then Day. That is a **striking motif parallel** (typological; the "night before day" order is discussed for Gen 1:5 in the comparative literature; verify a specific study).
  - **Gen 1:6–8**: Ouranos lying on Earth until separated (176–182) ↔ the separation of the waters and of heaven from earth (as in Enūma eliš IV; the Song of the Hoe). **Accepted** as a widespread motif.
  - **Gen 1:21, the current commentary unit**: Pontos begets Keto (Κητώ, 238). Her brood with Phorkys are the sea monsters (270–336): the Graiai, Gorgons, Echidna, and the serpent Ladon guarding the golden apples (333–335). The LXX renders *ha-tanninim ha-gedolim* as τὰ κήτη τὰ μεγάλα, so for a reader of the LXX layer (guidelines §6.4) the word κῆτος is *Hesiodic* sea-monster vocabulary. Typhoeus (820–880): ἑκατὸν κεφαλαὶ ὀφιος, δεινοῖο δράκοντος… ἐκ δέ οἱ ὀσσων… πῦρ αἰμάρυσσεν (825–827, verified) ↔ Leviathan: "out of his mouth go burning torches… out of his nostrils goes smoke" (Job 41:10–13); Isa 27:1 (LXX δράκων); Ps 74:13–14. The Typhon ↔ Ṣaphon (Mount Kasios, Ex 14:2 Baal-zephon) link is **accepted** (Fontenrose 1959; West 1966, 1997; Lane Fox 2008; López-Ruiz 2010). This is the strongest Greek text for the *tanninim*.
  - **Gen 2:7, 2:22**: Hephaestus mixes earth and water and gives the first woman voice and strength (WD 60–82); Th. 570–589 has the "race of women". **Accepted** as a classic comparison (Pandora/Eve). Most scholars see a typological, not genetic, link; the misogyny is far stronger than in Gen 2–3.
  - **Gen 3:16–19**: "the gods keep livelihood (βίος) hidden from men" (WD 42, verified). "Before, the tribes of men lived on earth apart from evils, without hard toil and grievous sicknesses" (90–92, verified). "Before excellence the gods have set *sweat*" (ἱδρῶτα, 289, verified) ↔ "by the sweat of your face shall you eat bread". The labour-as-curse frame is **accepted** as a parallel (Pandora's jar ↔ the expulsion).
  - **Gen 1:29 / 2:16**: the golden race, for whom "the grain-giving field bore fruit of itself" (αὐτομάτη, 117–118, verified).
  - **Gen 5 and 6:1–4**: the silver race's hundred-year childhood (130–131) ↔ the antediluvian life-spans. The **fourth race, "the godly race of hero-men, who are called *hēmitheoi*, the former generation"** (159–160, verified) ↔ "the *gibborim* of old, the men of renown". **Accepted** comparison (Hendel 1987, JBL 106; Van Seters 1992; West 1997).
  - **Daniel 2**: the metals sequence (accepted, with a common Near Eastern/Iranian background debated).
  - **Gen 4:3–5 and 8:20–21**: the Mekone sacrifice (535–616) is an aetiology of sacrifice. Men get the meat, the gods the bones wrapped in fat, smoke rising. It ends a primeval commensality of gods and men (ὅτ' ἐκρίνοντο θεοὶ θνητοί τ' ἀνθρωποι, "when gods and mortal men were being separated", 535, verified). Compare the post-flood sacrifice and the "pleasing odour" (8:21) and the fat for God in Lev 3:3–5, 7:23–25. The parallel is **noted in the literature, typological**.
  - **Gen 11:1–9** (weak): the Titans' revolt; and see Od. 11.305–320 below.
  - **Lev 26 / Deut 28**: the just city prospers, with peace, crops, acorns, bees, sheep and children who resemble their fathers; the unjust city gets famine, plague, barren women and lost ships (WD 225–247). This is a close **structural** parallel to blessings and curses (West 1978 commentary; accepted as a motif).
  - **Judg 9:8–15; 2 Kgs 14:9**: the hawk and the nightingale (202–212), the earliest Greek fable (genre parallel).
  - **Proverbs**: WD 342–346, call the neighbour to the feast, "neighbours come ungirt, kinsmen stay to gird themselves" ↔ Prov 27:10 "better a neighbour near than a brother far" (close; noted by West). WD 265–266, "a man contriving evil for another contrives it for himself" ↔ Prov 26:27; Ps 7:16.
  - **Amos 5:8, Job 9:9, 38:31**: "when the Pleiades and Hyades and the might of Orion set, then remember ploughing" (615–617, verified). The same constellations, *kimah* and *kesil*, are the Bible's markers of the year. The Gezer calendar is the Hebrew counterpart of the farmer's year.
  - **Gen 2:3; Lev 23**: "the first, the fourth and the seventh, a holy day (ἑβδόμη ἱερὸν ἦμαρ), for on it Leto bore Apollo" (770–771, verified). It is a *monthly* seventh, not a week, but a holy seventh day. Compare the Babylonian hemerologies.
  - **Deut 23:13–15; Lev 15:16–18**: the purity taboos of WD 724–759, which bar urinating facing the sun and bid washing after intercourse before a libation.
  - **Prophetic call narratives** (Amos 7:14–15; Ex 3; Isa 6; Jer 1): the Muses take a shepherd, give him a staff and breathe a divine voice into him (Th. 22–34; **accepted** thematic parallel).
- *Soul of the ancients.* It is the earliest Greek "I": a poet who quarrels with his brother, hates his village ("Ascra, bad in winter, hard in summer, good never"), fears debt, and trusts Zeus' justice against the bribe-eating lords. It shows a whole worldview, from the first gap to the right day to cut your nails, and a cosmos born by sex and violence that ends in a just king.

- *Base text and tools.*
  - Base: Perseus `canonical-greekLit` `tlg0020.tlg001/002/003.perseus-grc2.xml`, Evelyn-White's 1914 Loeb text (public domain); repository licence CC BY-SA 4.0 (verified in `README.md`). The files carry no `<licence>` element; Herodotus' file does.
  - **Perseus Treebank** `treebank_data/v2.1/Greek/texts/tlg0020.tlg001.perseus-grc1.tb.xml`: 8,234 words in 437 sentences, every word with lemma, postag and syntax (verified); also WD and Shield.
  - Check against the standard editions, West 1966 (Theogony, Oxford) and 1978 (WD), Solmsen OCT³ 1990, and the Loeb Most 2006/2018 (all ©). New: **Clay & Vergados, *Hesiod: Theogony* (CUP Green & Yellow, 2025)**, with text after West, a list of departures, a 260-page commentary and an introduction on the Near Eastern background (reported, from the Classics for All review).
  - Dictionaries: LSJ (Logeion API, verified; Perseus `lexica` XML on GitHub raw, verified); Cunliffe's *Lexicon of the Homeric Dialect* (1924; archive.org, reported).
  - Studies: West 1997 *The East Face of Helicon*; Burkert 1992; Penglase 1994; López-Ruiz 2010 *When the Gods Were Born* and 2025 *Greek Mythology: From Creation to First Humans* (OUP); Scully 2015 *Hesiod's Theogony: From Near Eastern Creation Myths to Paradise Lost*; Clay & Gilan 2014 on the Hittite "Song of Emergence" (Philologus; verify); Kelly & Metcalf (eds.) 2021 *Gods and Mortals in Early Greek and Near Eastern Mythology* (CUP; verify); Louden 2019 *Greek Myth and the Bible* (Routledge, verified title).
  - **Hebrew:** Shlomo Spann, *שירת הסיודוס* (Mossad Bialik 1956, all three poems); Aharon Shabtai, *עבודות וימים* (Schocken 2004, with large Theogony extracts in an appendix); Shimon Bouzaglo, *תאוגוניה* (Even Hoshen 2017); Yehuda Liebes, the Theogony proem (online, cited by Hebrew Wikipedia). All reported via simania, booksefer and Hebrew Wikipedia; none is public domain; none has a Near Eastern apparatus.
- *Feasibility and risks.* Low risk. The Greek is archaic but thoroughly studied, with full morphological data. Evelyn-White's text differs from West's in a few hundred places; the apparatus should note West's readings (from the commentaries, not copied wholesale). The size (1,850 lines) is comparable to Enūma eliš plus companions.
- *Benefit*: Bible **HIGH** / Soul **HIGH**. *Recommendation*: **translate first**: Theogony and Works and Days as one complete corpus, keyed to Gen 1–11 and the Kumarbi cycle and Enūma eliš (already done in this folder).

2.2 Homer, the *Iliad* and the *Odyssey* (selected books)

Epic Greek (Kunstsprache: Ionic with Aeolic and Arcado-Cypriot/Mycenaean layers) · composition: Iliad c. 750–680, Odyssey c. 725–650 BCE (Janko's linguistic dating; West argues 680–640 for the Iliad); the oral-formulaic tradition (Parry–Lord) reaches back in places to the Mycenaean age (the boar's-tusk helmet, the tower shield, "silver-studded sword"); fixation by dictation or a "Peisistratean" text in the 6th c. is debated · earliest witnesses: Ptolemaic papyri (3rd c. BCE, the "wild" papyri); Venetus A (Marc. gr. 822, 10th c.) for the Iliad · Iliad 15,687 lines, Odyssey 12,107 (verified counts) · complete.

- *What it is.* An ancient hearer heard the wrath of Achilles and its cost; the gods as a quarrelsome family above a mortal war; the funeral of Patroclus; Priam kissing the hands that killed his son. In the Odyssey: a man's return through monsters to a wife and a son, and a visit to the dead.

- *Bible parallels* (the selection is built on these):
  - **Il. 11.27–28** τρεῖς ἑκάτερθ' ἰρισσιν ἐοικότες, ἄς τε Κρονίων / ἐν νέφεϊ στήριξε, τέρας μερόπων ἀνθρώπων, "three on each side like rainbows, which the son of Kronos fixed in the cloud, a sign for mortal men" (verified). Also **17.547–549**: Zeus stretches the purple rainbow from heaven "to be a sign (τέρας) of war or of cold storm" (verified). ↔ **Gen 9:13–16**, *qashti natatti be-ʿanan ve-hayeta le-ʾot*. Bow, cloud, the god who sets it, and "sign" all coincide; the meaning differs (an omen of war or storm vs. a covenant against the flood). Also compare Marduk's bow set in heaven (Enūma eliš VI 82–91, already in this folder). The parallel is noted in commentaries; verify a specific study. **High value for the empty Gen 8:20–11:26 block.**
  - **Od. 11.305–320**: Iphimedeia "said she had lain with Poseidon"; her sons Otus and Ephialtes, nine cubits broad and nine fathoms tall, threatened the gods: "they longed to set Ossa on Olympus, and on Ossa leafy Pelion, ἵν' οὐρανὸς ἁμβατὸς εἰή, so that heaven might be scalable" (verified). Apollo killed them before their beards grew. ↔ **Gen 6:4** (sons of a god by a mortal woman; giants) and **Gen 11:4** (*ve-rosho va-shamayim*). The Babel comparison is old and **accepted as typological**.
  - **Il. 14.201, 246**: Ὠκεανόν τε θεῶν γένεσιν καὶ μητέρα Τηθύν; Ὠκεανοῦ, ὅς περ γένεσις πάντεσσι τέτυκται (verified) ↔ Apsû and Tiāmat, and *tehom*, Gen 1:2. **Accepted** as Near Eastern (Burkert 1992; West 1997).
  - **Il. 15.187–193**: the three sons of Kronos cast lots for sky, sea and underworld ↔ Atraḫasis I 11–16 (**accepted**, Burkert); Deut 32:8–9 (the division of the nations).
  - **Il. 1**: the priest of Apollo Smintheus (1.39, "of the mice") is dishonoured; plague, ransom and propitiation ↔ **1 Sam 5–6** (plague, golden "mice", the ark returned with a guilt offering). The parallel is old and debated but often cited. The sacrifice scene 1.447–474 (barley, slaughter, thigh-bones wrapped in fat, a double fold, wine, the savour rising) ↔ Lev 1, 3:3–5, 7:30–34 (the thigh, the fat).
  - **Il. 3.276–301** (oath sacrifice: "whoever first violates the oaths, may their brains flow on the ground like this wine") ↔ Gen 15, Jer 34:18. Optional add-on.
  - **Il. 6.146–149**, οἵη περ φύλλων γενεὴ τοίη δὲ καὶ ἀνδρῶν (verified) ↔ Isa 40:6–8, Ps 103:15–16, Job 14:1–2, and almost verbatim Sir 14:18 (**accepted**). Bellerophon (6.155–202): the false accusation by the king's wife ↔ **Gen 39** (accepted motif; also the Egyptian Two Brothers); the "baneful signs on a folded tablet" ordering the bearer's death ↔ **2 Sam 11:14–15** (accepted).
  - **Il. 23.1–257**: the ghost of Patroclus "like smoke, gibbering" (23.100–101) ↔ 1 Sam 28 and Isa 8:19, 29:4 (the chirping dead). Achilles cuts his hair for the dead and Patroclus' pyre gets animals and twelve captives (23.141–183) ↔ the bans of Lev 19:27–28, 21:5 and Deut 14:1. This is a strong ritual control for the law blocks.
  - **Il. 24.527–533**: δοιοὶ γάρ τε πίθοι κατακείαται ἐν Διὸς οὐδει / δώρων οἷα δίδωσι κακῶν, ἕτερος δὲ ἑάων (verified) ↔ Job 2:10, Qoh 7:14, Isa 45:7 (accepted thematic parallel).
  - **Od. 11 (Nekyia)**: the pit, the blood the dead must drink to speak ↔ 1 Sam 28; Lev 17:11–14 and Deut 12:23 (blood is the *nefesh*); Deut 18:11. Achilles: "I would rather be a serf on the land of another, a man without lot, than rule over all the perished dead" (11.489–491, verified) ↔ **Qoh 9:4** "a living dog is better than a dead lion" (accepted).
  - **Od. 12** (optional): the forbidden cattle of the Sun; eating them brings death ↔ Gen 2–3 (Louden 2011).
  - **Il. 2.484–877, the Catalogue of Ships** (~394 lines): a list framed by an invocation, "the multitude I could not tell… unless the Muses…" (2.488–492). It is a **genre** parallel to the Table of Nations (Gen 10), the census lists (Num 1–2, 26) and the tribal geography (Josh 13–19). MEDIUM; the Catalogue of Women (2.4) is the better Gen 10 parallel. Include it only if the Gen 10 commentary wants a list-form control.
  - General studies: Gordon 1955/1962 (*Homer and Bible*; pioneering, sometimes overstated); West 1997; Louden 2011 *Homer's Odyssey and the Near East* (CUP); Louden 2019; Bachvarova 2016 *From Hittite to Homer* (CUP); Haubold 2013 *Greece and Mesopotamia*. Dennis MacDonald's "mimesis" readings concern the NT and are **largely rejected**; not relevant here.
- *Soul of the ancients.* It is the best-studied oral tradition in the world and the West's founding picture of grief, honour and pity. Iliad 24 is perhaps the most humane scene of ancient literature. Odyssey 11 is the Greek mind before death: the mother whom Odysseus three times tries to embrace (11.204–208).
- *Base text and tools.*
  - Base: Perseus `tlg0012.tlg001.perseus-grc2.xml` (Monro & Allen, OCT 1908–1920; public domain) and `tlg0012.tlg002.perseus-grc2.xml` (Murray, Loeb 1919; public domain), both verified; Iliad book line-counts verified (Il. 1 = 611, 6 = 529, 9 = 709, 23 = 897, 24 = 804).
  - Treebanked in full (`tlg0012.tlg001/002.perseus-grc1.tb.xml`, verified in the listing).
  - Modern editions (West's Teubner Iliad 1998–2000; van Thiel; West's Odyssey 2017) are ©. Commentaries: the Cambridge Iliad commentary (Kirk ed., 6 vols.), the Oxford Odyssey commentary (Heubeck et al.), Basel *Gesamtkommentar* (all ©, consult).
  - Dictionaries: Cunliffe 1924 and Autenrieth (public domain); LSJ (Logeion). Scholia: Homer Multitext (homermultitext.org reachable, 200). The Chicago Homer is blocked (connection refused).
  - **Hebrew:**
    - **Shaul Tchernichovsky**, Iliad (Stybel, 1930 per the Malta Classics list; Hebrew Wikisource gives תרצ"ד, so verify the year) and Odyssey (Dvir/Schocken 1940–1942; collected Schocken 1954). Both are on **Project Ben-Yehuda** (`benyehuda.org/read/5526` Iliad, `/read/5592` Odyssey, each about 1.2–1.4 MB of text, verified), public domain. Translated from the Greek in hexameters.
    - Ahuvia Kahana, Odyssey (Keter 1996; reported, Hebrew Wikisource).
    - **Avraham Aroeti**, Iliad (Magnes 2012, 2nd ed. 2016, artistic prose, 554 pp., verified on the Magnes page) and Odyssey (Magnes 2012, reported).
    - **Aharon Shabtai**, Odyssey (Schocken 2014) and Iliad (Schocken 2016) (reported via Hebrew Wikipedia).
    - Also reported: Arieh Stav (Iliad 2009) and Yosef Nave (1995); verify both.

- *Feasibility and risks.* Low linguistic risk. The real question is **value added**: four modern Hebrew Homers exist. Recommendation: **no full translation**. Translate a selection of about 3,800 lines (Il. 1, 6, 11.1–46, 14.153–360, 15.184–199, 23.1–257, 24; Od. 11), justified by the parallels above, with the apparatus as the product. Tchernichovsky, being public domain, can be quoted freely as a register reference (rank 6).
- *Benefit*: Bible **MED-HIGH** (HIGH for Gen 9:13 and Gen 11:4) / Soul **HIGH**. *Recommendation*: second in the region, as a selection.

2.3 The Hesiodic *Catalogue of Women* (and the Epic Cycle's primeval fragments)

Epic Greek · composition c. 580–520 BCE (West 1985, on genealogical and historical grounds) or late 7th c. (others); debated · witnesses: Oxyrhynchus and Berlin papyri (1st–3rd c. CE) and quotations · five books; about 1,000+ lines survive in pieces · badly fragmentary.

- *What it is.* It is a genealogy of the heroic age arranged by mortal women who lay with gods: "Or like her who..." (*ē hoiē*, hence *Ehoiai*). It runs from Deucalion and Pyrrha through Hellen and his sons to the eve of the Trojan War.
- *Bible parallels.*
  - Fr. 1 (proem): "for then feasts were shared, and seats shared, by immortal gods and mortal men" ↔ **Gen 6:1–2** (accepted).
  - Fr. 204.95–123 M-W (= 155 Most): Zeus plans to destroy the race of the demigods, "so that the children of the gods should not mate with wretched mortals" ↔ **Gen 6:3–7** (accepted as close; Hendel 1987; West 1985; Clay; Koenen 1994).
  - Fr. 2–10 M-W: Deucalion → Hellen → Dorus, Xuthus, Aeolus; Xuthus → Achaeus and **Ion** ↔ the eponym genealogy of **Gen 10** (Javan = Ion, Gen 10:2, 4; Van Seters 1992 *Prologue to History*, which argues that the Yahwist knew Greek genealogical historiography; that thesis is debated). This is the best Greek control for the **Table of Nations**, which has no commentary yet.
  - The **Cypria fr. 1** (West, Loeb Epic Cycle): Earth is burdened by the multitude of men, and Zeus plans the Trojan War to relieve her ↔ Atraḫasis (noise, too many people) and Gen 6:5–7 (accepted; Burkert, West).
  - Deucalion's flood: Cat. fr. 2–7; Pindar *Ol.* 9.41–56; later Apollodorus 1.7.2 ↔ Gen 6–9 (accepted motif; possibly dependent on the Near East).
- *Soul.* Medium: names and marriages, but also Mestra, who changes shape to feed her father, and Atalanta's race.
- *Base text and tools.* Merkelbach & West 1967 (OCT; ©) is the standard; Most, Loeb 2006/2018 (©); Hirschberger 2004 commentary (©); Ormand 2014. Public domain: Rzach's Teubner 1902/1913 and Evelyn-White's Loeb 1914, but both predate many papyri, and Perseus does not have the fragments. Greek OCR on archive.org is unusable. The base text would have to be built from Most/M-W and kept local (not committed).
- *Feasibility.* Medium-low: a copyrighted base, gaps, and a heavy apparatus of supplements.
- *Benefit*: Bible **HIGH** (Gen 6:1–4, Gen 10) / Soul **MEDIUM**. *Recommendation*: a **short excerpt project** (fr. 1, 2–10, 204, plus Cypria fr. 1, about 250 lines) attached to the Hesiod corpus. Do not attempt the whole.

2.4 Archaic Greek laws and sacred laws (a corpus)

Epigraphic Greek (Cretan Doric, Attic, Theran/Cyrenaean Doric, Ionic) · the inscriptions are themselves the originals · c. 650–300 BCE.

- **Gortyn Code** (IC IV 72; the "Great Code"; inscription c. 480–450 BCE, with older laws behind it; 12 columns of boustrophedon, about 600 lines; nearly complete).
  - Contents: procedure (no seizure before trial), rape and adultery, divorce, children of divorced and slave women, inheritance, the **heiress** (*patroiōkos*), adoption, and debt-bondage.
  - **Num 27:1–11 and 36**: the heiress must marry the nearest paternal kinsman (her father's brother, then his son). If she refuses, she keeps the house and half the rest and may marry within the tribe (*pyla*) (Fordham/Willetts translation, reported). This is a close structural parallel to the daughters of Zelophehad, who must marry "within the family of their father's tribe" (Num 36:6–12). The link is noted in comparative legal history (Westbrook; verify a specific study). The search found Gortyn heiress studies but none that compares Numbers directly, so this may be an **open comparison**.
  - Rape and seduction tariffs by status (II 2–45) ↔ Ex 22:15–16, Deut 22:23–29; slaves ↔ Ex 21:2–11, 20–21; the oath of the defendant ↔ Ex 22:7–10.
  - Base: Guarducci, *Inscriptiones Creticae* IV (1950), Willetts 1967 (De Gruyter; ©), Gagarin & Perlman 2016 *The Laws of Ancient Crete* (OUP; ©). Public domain: Bücheler & Zitelmann 1885 *Das Recht von Gortyn* (archive.org, verified in search); Merriam 1885–86, AJA (JSTOR Early Journal Content via archive.org). These are Greek OCR scans, so the text must be keyed. English: Roby 1886 (Ames Foundation PDF, verified, English only). **No open digital Greek text found**; PHI has it (Willetts' text) but answers 403.
- **Dreros law** (c. 650–600 BCE; the oldest Greek law on stone; constitutional: a *kosmos* may not hold office again within ten years; about 6 lines). Short; Soul value (the first "it pleased the city").
- **Draco's homicide law** (enacted 621/0, republished 409/8 BCE; IG I³ 104; about 60 lines, the first 20 legible).
  - Text: "even if a man kills another not from forethought (μὴ 'κ προνοίας), he goes into exile". The kin may grant pardon (αἰδεσις) if all agree; slayers abroad may not be pursued.
  - ↔ **Num 35:9–34, Deut 19:1–13, Ex 21:12–14**: intent vs. accident, exile, the kin as prosecutors (*goʾel ha-dam*). It is a widely cited typological parallel. The specific comparative studies need verifying; a 2026 search found none quickly.
  - Base: Stroud 1968 (©); IG I³ (©). Public domain: IG I² 115 (1924) and Dittenberger *Syll.*³ 111 (verify).

- **Selinous lex sacra** (lead tablet, c. 475–450 BCE; Jameson, Jordan & Kotansky 1993, GRBS Monographs 11, Duke; two columns).
  - Sacrifices to the Tritopatores, "the pure" and "the impure", and the purification of a man pursued by an *elasteros* (avenging spirit) after bloodshed.
  - ↔ Num 35:33–34 (blood pollutes the land), Num 19, Lev 14.
  - The GRBS monograph PDF appears to be open on the GRBS site (a search hit), but its host was unreachable today; verify.
- **Cyrene cathartic law** (SEG 9.72 = IGCyr 016700 = CGRN 99; inscription c. 330–300 BCE, presenting itself as Apollo's oracle to the founders, 7th c. tradition).
  - "Apollo declared: forever to dwell in Libya using purifications, abstinences and tithes" (verified).
  - Childbirth defiles "the roof" (ὑπώροφον): those under the same roof are defiled, those outside are not ↔ **Num 19:14** (*ha-ʾohel*!) and Lev 12.
  - A man who has lain with a woman by night may sacrifice; by day, after washing ↔ Lev 15:16–18.
  - Also tithes, the first-fruits of the sanctuary's wood, suppliants and "visitants" (ἱκέσιοι).
  - Base: **IGCyr EpiDoc XML**, `igcyr.unibo.it/igcyr/igcyr016700.xml`, **CC BY-NC 4.0** (verified, 119 KB, with full Greek). This is a model open base text.
- **Teos Dirae** ("Teian imprecations", c. 480–450 BCE; ML 30 / Nomima I; two stelae).
  - The city's officials curse yearly "whoever makes harmful drugs against the Teians… whoever prevents grain being imported… whoever betrays…: may he perish, himself and his family" ↔ **Deut 27:15–26** (the public *arur* liturgy) and Lev 26.
  - A strong structural parallel; reported.
  - Base: ML (©); Dittenberger *Syll.*³ 37–38 (public domain; verify).
- **CGRN** (Collection of Greek Ritual Norms, Liège; about 222–250 edited, translated "sacred laws", EpiDoc, open access) is **unreachable from this session** (connection refused at both `cgrn.ulg.ac.be` and `cgrn.uliege.be`). Sokolowski's LSCG, LSAM and LSS (1955–69) and Lupu's NGSL are ©.
- *Soul.* How a city legislated memory ("this is what the Gortynians decided"), fear of pollution, a curse as civic institution.
- *Feasibility.* Medium. Cretan Doric is learnable (and there are glossaries in Willetts and Gagarin–Perlman), the size is moderate, and the parallels are concrete. The hurdle is keying the Greek from editions (Gortyn) and copyright on the best texts.
- **Hebrew:** none found.
- *Benefit*: Bible **HIGH** / Soul **MED-HIGH**. *Recommendation*: **a "Greek laws" project after Hesiod**, in the existing `חוקים-ובריתות/` corpus: Gortyn (all), Draco, Cyrene, Selinous, Teos, Dreros.

2.5 The Homeric Hymns

Epic Greek · Demeter c. 650–550, Aphrodite c. 700–650, Apollo (Delian + Pythian) 7th–6th c. (perhaps assembled for Delos 523/522), Hermes c. 520–480 BCE (all debated within decades) · Demeter survives in one manuscript (Leiden BPG 33H, 14th–15th c., found in Moscow 1777); the others in a family of 15th-c. mss · 33 hymns, 2,342 lines (verified count; Demeter 498, Apollo 552, Hermes 586, Aphrodite 293) · good.

- *What it is.*
  - **Demeter**: the rape of Persephone, the mother's search and fast. Disguised as an old nurse at Eleusis, she tries to make the baby Demophon immortal in the fire and is interrupted by his mother. The famine stops the gods' sacrifices; then the compromise of the pomegranate seed and the founding of the Mysteries.
  - **Apollo**: the god's birth on Delos and the killing of the she-dragon at Pytho.
  - **Hermes**: a baby who steals Apollo's cattle and invents the lyre on his first day.
  - **Aphrodite**: the goddess seduces the mortal Anchises and foretells their son.
- *Bible parallels.*
  - Apollo kills the δράκαινα at Pytho (Hymn 3.300–374), and Hera bears Typhaon in anger: dragon combat ↔ Ps 74:13–14, Isa 51:9, Gen 1:21 (typological; accepted as part of the Typhon/Ṣaphon complex).
  - Demophon's failed immortalization ↔ Gen 3:22 (the gods' guarded boundary; typological) and the Isis-at-Byblos story (Plutarch).
  - Gods walking disguised among mortals and rewarding hospitality ↔ Gen 18–19 (motif).
  - Aphrodite and Anchises: a goddess with a mortal man; Tithonus' immortality without youth ↔ Gen 6:3 and the limits of life (typological).
- *Soul.* HIGH: grief, the mother's rage, the Mysteries' promise ("blessed is he of men on earth who has seen these", Dem. 480), and a comic hymn.
- *Base text and tools.* Perseus `tlg0013.tlg001–033` (Evelyn-White 1914; public domain), verified; the Demeter hymn is treebanked (`tlg0013.tlg002.perseus-grc1.tb.xml`). Richardson 1974 (Demeter commentary, ©), Faulkner 2008 (Aphrodite), Vergados 2013 (Hermes), West Loeb 2003 (©). **Hebrew:** Shlomo Spann, *ההמנונות ההומריים* (Hebrew University press association, Jerusalem 1946; preface by M. Schwabe; reported, from the Princeton catalogue). That is old, so a new apparatus-rich translation adds a lot.
- *Feasibility.* Excellent.
- *Benefit*: Bible **MEDIUM** / Soul **HIGH**. *Recommendation*: translate Demeter + Aphrodite + Apollo (about 1,350 lines), with Hermes optional; pairs naturally with the Descent of Ištar and the Netherworld corpus already in the folder.

2.6 The Orphic corpus: the Derveni papyrus and the gold tablets

Derveni papyrus: Greek prose with quoted hexameters · Orphic poem c. 500 BCE (or earlier); commentary c. 420–400 BCE · the roll is from a funeral pyre at Derveni near Thessaloniki, c. 340–320 BCE (found 1962): the oldest surviving Greek literary manuscript and "the oldest European book" · 26 columns, the tops only (the bottoms burned) · damaged.

- *What it is.* First, ritual instructions on sacrifices to the souls and the Eumenides, by a *mantis*. Then a line-by-line commentary on an Orphic theogony: Night prophesies to Zeus; Zeus "swallows" the αἰδοῖον (the phallus? or the "revered one", Protogonos) of Ouranos and becomes the one from whom all is made. "Zeus the head, Zeus the middle, from Zeus all things are fashioned." Zeus then desires to mate with his mother. The commentator explains, word by word and by etymology, that it all means physics, with Mind and air as the principle.
- *Bible parallels.* A cosmogony re-made by a single god who "swallows" and re-creates ↔ Gen 1 monotheizing creation (typological). The strongest point is **the method**: the earliest preserved Greek allegoresis, quasi-lemmatic, explaining why the poet chose a strange word (e.g., col. XXIII: "Okeanos" is air). That anticipates the Alexandrian, Philonic and rabbinic word-by-word commentary, and the `פירוש`/'s own "reverse-engineering test". I found no study comparing it directly with biblical exegesis (a 2026 search), so this point would be the project's own.
- **Gold tablets** ("Orphic" or Bacchic lamellae; c. 400 BCE (Hipponion) to 2nd–3rd c. CE (Rome); about 40 texts, 2–16 lines each; good).
  - The soul's instructions in Hades: "you will find on the left a spring, and beside it a white cypress; do not even approach it. You will find another, cold water flowing from the lake of Memory." The guards; "say: *I am a child of Earth and of starry Heaven, but my race is heavenly… I am parched with thirst and perishing; give me quickly cold water*" (Petelia, verified in First1KGreek). The Pelinna ivy leaves: "now you have died and now you have been born, thrice blessed, on this day".
  - Bible: the two springs and the tree ↔ Gen 2:9–10 (typological); "child of Earth and Heaven" ↔ Gen 2:7; thirst ↔ Ps 42:2–3, Jer 2:13 ("fountain of living waters").
  - The Olbia bone plates (5th c. BCE) read "life · death · life · truth · Dio(nysos) · Orphikoi".
- *Soul.* HIGH: what an initiate hoped for at death, the passwords of the dead.
- *Base text and tools.*
  - **Derveni**: Kouremenos, Parássoglou & Tsantsanoglou 2006 (Olschki; ©). The CHS project page (`www-current.chs.harvard.edu/publications-projects-derveni/`, verified) links the *editio princeps* text online "© Olschki", Franco Ferrari's new edition of cols. I–VI, and a multiversion view. Other editions: Janko 2002 (ZPE 141; interim text), Bernabé PEG II.3 (2007), Betegh 2004 (©); Santamaría (ed.) 2019 *The Derveni Papyrus: Unearthing Ancient Mysteries* (CHS/Brill; verify the OA status).
  - **Tablets**: First1KGreek `tlg0579.tlg010.1st1K-grc1.xml` (Diels, *Orphica* DK 1, CC BY-SA, verified); Kern 1922 *Orphicorum fragmenta* (public domain, archive.org; **OCR unusable**, verified). **Tzifopoulos 2010 *Paradise Earned: The Bacchic-Orphic Gold Lamellae of Crete*** (CHS Hellenic Studies 23, free online, CC 3.0; reported, page 200). Graf & Johnston 2013 *Ritual Texts for the Afterlife*² (©), Bernabé & Jiménez San Cristóbal 2008 (©), Edmonds (ed.) 2011 (©; a PDF on an AUTh server may be unauthorized, so avoid it).
  - **Hebrew:** none found.
- *Feasibility.* Derveni: medium-low (heavy supplements; copyright; consult online, keep local). Tablets: easy.
- *Benefit*: Bible **MEDIUM** / Soul **HIGH**. *Recommendation*: a small project: all the gold tablets (about 300 lines), plus the Derveni columns with the theogony quotations (cols. VII–XXVI, selected), with an introduction on the method.

2.7 The Roman archaic law and ritual corpus (Old Latin)

Old Latin · 6th–2nd c. BCE; the songs and formulae are older than their witnesses · witnesses: inscriptions (Lapis Niger c. 570–550; Duenos vase c. 600–550; Lex Spoletina c. 240; SC de Bacchanalibus 186 BCE, the Tiriolo bronze; Scipionic elogia 3rd–2nd c.; Acta Arvalium 218 CE, CIL VI 2104); the rest is quotations (the Twelve Tables in Cicero, Gaius, Festus, Gellius; Carmen Saliare in Varro; the fetial and devotio formulae in Livy; Cato's DAC in a 9th–15th c. tradition) · in all about 600–800 lines.

- *What it is.*
  - **Twelve Tables** (451–450 BCE): about 100 reconstructed clauses on summons, debt (the debtor cut in pieces, III.6), family, inheritance, property, torts and sacral law.
  - **Carmen Arvale**: "enos Lases iuvate… satur fu, fere Mars… triumpe" (verified). A priests' dance-song to Mars and the Lares.
  - **Cato, De Agri Cultura**: offerings to Mars Silvanus for the oxen (83), Jupiter Dapalis (132), the *porca praecidanea* (134), the expiation before thinning a grove (139, *si deus si dea es*: "whether you are god or goddess"), the suovetaurilia lustration of the farm (141, verified), and the charm for a dislocation (160).
  - **Fetial treaty oath** (Livy 1.24): "if the Roman people first defect… on that day, Jupiter, strike the Roman people as I here today shall strike this pig". Livy 1.32: the declaration of war.
  - **Devotio** of Decius (Livy 8.9) and **evocatio** (Macrobius 3.9).
  - The Lapis Niger's *sakros esed* (a curse on violating the place), the Lex Spoletina's "let no one violate this grove", the Scipionic epitaphs.

- *Bible parallels.*
  - **Ex 21:23–25**: "si membrum rupsit, ni cum eo pacit, talio esto" (VIII.2, verified): talion unless settled by composition. Classic, **accepted**, cited in every Ex 21 commentary; the settlement clause ↔ Ex 21:30 (*kofer*).
  - **Ex 22:1–2**: the night thief may be killed (VIII.12), the day thief not unless he resists with a weapon (VIII.13) (**accepted**, close).
  - **Ex 22:17 / Deut 18:10**: *qui malum carmen incantassit* (VIII.1, verified) and *qui fruges excantassit*.
  - **Deut 21:18–21 vs. patria potestas**; **Deut 22:9–11** (none); **Deut 24:1–4**.
  - Westbrook 1988 (ZSS Rom. Abt. 105) argued that the Twelve Tables belong to the Near Eastern legal tradition (debated; verify the citation).
  - The fetial oath ↔ **Gen 15:9–18, Jer 34:18–20** (self-curse by an animal) and Sefire. **Accepted** typological (Weinfeld; Hillers).
  - Devotio and evocatio ↔ *ḥerem* (Josh 6–7; Deut 20:16–18) and the gods of a besieged city (2 Kgs 18:25; Isa 10:10–11) (typological, discussed).
  - Cato's lustration ↔ Lev 1–3, 14 (circumambulation, three animals, the formula of request). *Si deus si dea es* ↔ the unknown sin offering (Lev 4–5)?
  - The SC de Bacchanalibus ↔ Deut 13 (suppression of a secret foreign cult; typological).
- *Soul.* MED-HIGH: a farmer's prayer against "diseases seen and unseen, barrenness and destruction", the Arval brothers' archaic dance, the epitaph of a Scipio, a household charm.
- *Base text and tools.*
  - The Latin Library `12tables.html`, `carmenarvale.html`, `cato/cato.agri.html` (verified).
  - LacusCurtius Cato (Goetz Teubner 1922 + Hooper & Ash Loeb 1934; "both text and translation are in the public domain", verified).
  - CIL I² (public domain volumes on archive.org; Latin OCR acceptable); Bruns, *Fontes iuris Romani antiqui*[7] (1909, public domain); Crawford (ed.) 1996 *Roman Statutes* (©, the modern standard for the Twelve Tables); Warmington ROL (Loeb 1935–40; US status unclear).
  - Dictionaries: Lewis & Short (Perseus `lexica` XML on raw GitHub, verified); OLD (©); de Vaan 2008 *Etymological Dictionary of Latin and the other Italic Languages* (Brill; ©).
  - **Hebrew:** none found for these texts (verify a Twelve Tables translation in Hebrew legal-history literature).
- *Feasibility.* Good. Latin is excellently resourced; archaic forms (*rupsit, faxsit, duonos*) are well documented.
- *Benefit*: Bible **MED-HIGH** (HIGH for Ex 21–22) / Soul **MED-HIGH**. *Recommendation*: one project, "the Roman archaic formulae", folded into `/חוקים-ובריתות`.

2.8 Archaic lyric and elegy

Greek (Lesbian Aeolic, Ionic, Doric) · Archilochus c. 680–640; Alcman c. 620–600; Sappho and Alcaeus c. 610–570; Tyrtaeus c. 650; Solon c. 594; Mimnermus c. 630; Semonides 7th c.; the Theognidea c. 550–480 (a compilation) · witnesses: papyri (the Cologne Sappho, 3rd c. BCE; the Louvre Partheneion papyrus, 1st c. CE) and quotations; the Theognidea in medieval manuscripts (about 1,400 lines) · fragmentary except Theognis, Alcman's Partheneion (about 100 lines) and a few complete Sappho poems (fr. 1; 16; 31; 58, the "Tithonus poem", completed 2004).

- *Bible parallels.*
  - Solon fr. 27 West: the ten ages of man in hebdomads, the tenth ending at 70 ↔ **Ps 90:10** (accepted; Herodotus 1.32 has Solon give 70 years).
  - Theognis 425–428 ("best of all for men is not to be born… or to pass Hades' gates soonest") ↔ Qoh 4:2–3, Job 3:3–16 (accepted).
  - Mimnermus fr. 1–2 (the leaves of youth, old age) ↔ Qoh 12:1–7 and Il. 6.146.
  - Semonides fr. 7, the types of women created from animals, earth and sea ↔ the misogynist creation of woman (Gen 2–3 vs. Pandora) and Prov 31:10–31 (the bee-woman) (accepted as a parallel to Prov 31).
  - Archilochus fr. 122 (a solar eclipse: "nothing is beyond expectation now") ↔ Amos 8:9.
  - Alcman fr. 5 (P.Oxy. 2390): Thetis, Poros and Tekmor ("way" and "limit") as first principles ↔ Gen 1 and Prov 8:22–31 (typological).
  - Tyrtaeus ↔ Deut 20:1–9 (exhortation before battle).
- *Soul.* HIGH: the first personal voices of Europe (love, jealousy, exile, a soldier who threw away his shield).
- *Base text and tools.* The modern editions are ©: West *Iambi et Elegi Graeci*² (1989–92), Voigt 1971 (Sappho, Alcaeus), Page/Davies PMG(F), and Campbell's Loeb *Greek Lyric* (1982–93). Public domain: Bergk PLG⁴ (1882; scans, OCR unusable) and Edmonds' *Lyra Graeca* (Loeb 1922–27; vol. 1, 1922 on archive.org via DLI; status of that upload doubtful, so prefer other copies; verify). Perseus does not have the lyric poets. Greek Wikisource has some pages (its Heraclitus fragments page answered 200; the API was rate-limited, 429).
- **Hebrew:**
  - Shimon Bouzaglo, *מישהי, אני אומרת, תזכור אותנו* (Sappho, Even Hoshen 2009);
  - Yehuda Liebes, Sappho translations and essays (PDFs on `liebes.huji.ac.il`; reported);
  - Aharon Shabtai, *שירת יוון העתיקה* (2023; Archilochus, Sappho, Alcaeus, Anacreon, Simonides…; publisher to verify);
  - single poems in anthologies (e.g., poetrans.org).

  So Sappho is well covered; the others are partly covered.
- *Feasibility.* Medium (copyright on texts; fragmentary).
- *Benefit*: Bible **MEDIUM** / Soul **HIGH**. *Recommendation*: a selected **wisdom-and-mortality anthology** (Solon 4, 13, 27; Theognis selections; Mimnermus 1–2; Semonides 1 and 7; Archilochus 13, 122, 128; Alcman's Partheneion and fr. 5; Tyrtaeus 10–12), about 900 lines, rather than Sappho, who is translated.

2.9 The Umbrian Iguvine Tables

Umbrian (Sabellic) · the ritual tradition is older than the bronzes; Tablets I–Va in the Umbrian alphabet (c. 200–120 BCE?), Vb–VII in Latin letters (c. 100–70 BCE); found at Gubbio 1444 · 7 bronze tablets, about 4,500 words · well preserved; partly duplicated in two versions (I vs. VI–VII), which helps interpretation.

- *What it is.* The rule-book of the Atiedian Brethren of Iguvium.
  - The **lustration of the Fisian citadel**: birds observed before the rite; at each of three gates, sacrifices of oxen, pigs and lambs to Jupiter Grabovius, Mars Grabovius and Vofionus Grabovius; prayers repeated three times ("Jupiter Grabovius, I invoke thee with this perfect ox as an expiation for the Fisian mount…").
  - The **lustration of the people**, with the formal curse and expulsion of the Tadinates, Etruscans, Narcini and Iapudici.
  - Fees, the brotherhood's obligations, and a fine clause.
- *Bible parallels.* Lev 1–9 (the order of animals, the parts offered, colour and age specifications); the expulsion rite ↔ Lev 16:20–22 (the scapegoat; typological; also compare the Hittite rites, Anatolia agent); bird augury before action ↔ Deut 18:10, Gen 15:11? The comparison with Leviticus is mostly **unexplored** in scholarship: searches found only an LDS apologetics piece, which should be disregarded.
- *Soul.* HIGH: a whole communal liturgy in its own words, with fear of the enemy, purity, and a priest's meticulous checklist.
- *Base text and tools.*
  - **Poultney 1959 *The Bronze Tables of Iguvium*** (APA Monograph 18; text, translation, commentary, glossary). The archive.org copy `bronzetablesofig00poul` is University of Florida "copyright status reviewed – out of copyright" (verified via the metadata API). Another copy, `poultney-the-bronze-tables-of-iguvium-1959`, is a community upload: avoid it.
  - Buck 1904 *A Grammar of Oscan and Umbrian* (public domain; text, glossary; `grammarofoscanum00buckuoft`, OCR checked: usable, verified).
  - Bréal 1875 *Les tables eugubines* (public domain, archive.org).
  - Untermann 2000 *Wörterbuch des Oskisch-Umbrischen* (©); Weiss 2010 *Language and Ritual in Sabellic Italy* (Brill; ©; the best modern study of tablets VI–VII); Ancillotti & Cerri 1996/1997 (©).
  - Attalus has a page with links (`attalus.org/docs/iguvium.html`, reported).
  - **Hebrew:** none.
- *Feasibility and risks.* Medium-low. About 20–30% of the vocabulary is uncertain. An LLM must lean on Poultney's and Weiss' translations; that inverts the guidelines' rank order (translation as base), so every crux must be flagged.
- *Benefit*: Bible **MEDIUM** / Soul **HIGH**. *Recommendation*: possible later, as a "ritual of Italy" project together with Cato 141 (its Latin twin), and only with a heavy apparatus.

2.10 The Presocratic cosmogonies

Ionic prose or epic verse · Pherecydes of Syros c. 550, Anaximander c. 610–546, Xenophanes c. 570–475, Heraclitus c. 500, Parmenides c. 480, Empedocles c. 490–430 BCE · the witness is indirect: quotations in Aristotle, Theophrastus (doxography), Plutarch, Hippolytus, Sextus, Simplicius (6th c. CE); one direct papyrus, P.Strasb. gr. 1665–1666 (Empedocles, 1st c. CE, published 1999) · a few hundred fragments.

- *Bible parallels.*
  - **Pherecydes**: Zas, Chthonie and Chronos "always were"; Zas weds Chthonie and gives her a robe embroidered with Earth and Ogenos; **Ophioneus**, the serpent, fights Kronos and is cast into Ogenos ↔ Leviathan / the serpent (Gen 3:1, Isa 27:1). **Accepted** as Near Eastern-influenced (West 1971 *Early Greek Philosophy and the Orient*; Schibli 1990).
  - **Anaximander DK 12 A30**: the first humans were born inside fish, nursed until able to fend for themselves (A10–11) ↔ **Gen 1:20–23, the fifth day**: the living creatures of the waters as the first animal life, before land animals and man. This is typological, but directly on the unit now being commented.
  - **Empedocles B57–62**: limbs wandering apart and joining at random, then whole-natured forms ↔ Gen 1:20–25.
  - **Xenophanes B11–16, B23**: if oxen had hands they would draw gods like oxen; "one god, greatest… not like mortals in body or thought" ↔ Deut 4:15–19, Isa 40:18–25, 46:5. **Accepted** typological.
  - **Heraclitus** B5 (purification by blood is like washing mud with mud) ↔ Isa 1:11–17; B53 war, father of all.
  - Empedocles' *Purifications*: the exiled daimon and vegetarianism ↔ Gen 1:29 vs. 9:3.
- *Soul.* HIGH: the birth of a rational cosmos, against Homer and Hesiod.
- *Base text and tools.* Diels, *Die Fragmente der Vorsokratiker* (1903, 1912, 1922; public domain; on archive.org, OCR unusable; DK numbering). Laks & Most, Loeb *Early Greek Philosophy* (2016; ©); KRS 1983 (©). Greek Wikisource has Heraclitus' fragments (page 200). **Hebrew:** none found in a 2026 search (verify academic anthologies).
- *Feasibility.* Medium: a short corpus, but the base must be keyed by hand, and every fragment needs its source context.
- *Benefit*: Bible **MEDIUM** / Soul **HIGH**. *Recommendation*: a short "Greek cosmogonies" appendix to the Hesiod project: Pherecydes, Anaximander, Alcman fr. 5, the Derveni theogony, and Aristophanes *Birds* 693–702 (the Orphic egg). For the fifth day, Anaximander and *Birds* are the hook.

2.11 Greek curse tablets and archaic verse inscriptions

Greek · originals, 8th–4th c. BCE.

- *What it is.*
  - **Nestor's cup** (Pithekoussai, c. 740–720 BCE): "I am the cup of Nestor, good to drink from; whoever drinks from this cup, desire of fair-crowned Aphrodite will seize him at once". One of the oldest Greek writings, and a joke.
  - The **Dipylon oinochoe** (c. 740): "whoever of all the dancers now plays most delicately...".
  - The **Mantiklos Apollo** (c. 700): "Mantiklos dedicated me to the far-shooter of the silver bow... give him a pleasing return".
  - **Phrasikleia** (c. 540): "Tomb of Phrasikleia. *Kore* I shall be called forever, having received this name from the gods instead of marriage".
  - The **earliest *defixiones*** (Selinous, late 6th–5th c.; Attica 5th–4th c.): names bound, tongues bound.
- *Bible parallels.* Num 5:21–27 (a curse written and dissolved), Zech 5:1–4 (the flying scroll), Ps 109, Deut 27; votive formulas ↔ Gen 28:20–22 (Jacob's vow).
- *Base and tools.* Hansen, CEG 1 (1983, ©); Wünsch, *Defixionum Tabellae Atticae* (IG III App., 1897, public domain); Audollent 1904 (public domain); Gager 1992 (©); Eidinow 2007 (©). PHI is blocked (403). Scans only, so keying is needed.
- *Benefit*: Bible **MEDIUM** / Soul **HIGH**. *Recommendation*: a small "voices on objects" corpus (about 60 items), low cost, good companion to קולות-היום-יום/.

2.12 Linear B: the religious tablets

Mycenaean Greek in Linear B · Knossos c. 1400–1350 (LM II–IIIA), Pylos c. 1200–1180 BCE (burnt in the palace fire), also Thebes, Mycenae, Tiryns, Chania · the tablets are the originals · DAMOS holds about 5,900 documents in all (reported), mostly short · the selection is about 50 tablets.

- *What it is.*
  - **PY Tn 316**: a ritual in the month *po-ro-wi-to*: gold vessels and "*po-re-na*" (bearers? victims? debated) brought to *pa-ki-ja-ne* and to the shrines of Poseidon, Zeus, Hera, *Drimios son of Zeus*, *po-ti-ni-ja*, *ma-na-sa*, *di-wi-ja*, and *Hermes Areias*. It may be written in haste.
  - **PY Un 718**: contributions to Poseidon by the *wanax*, the *lawagetas* and the *damos*: wheat, wine, a bull, cheeses, sheepskins and **honey (*me-ri*)**.
  - **PY Fr**: perfumed oil to "the Divine Mother", to Poseidon, "for the anointing of robes".
  - **KN Fp 1**: oil to "all the gods" (*pa-si-te-o-i*), "the Mistress of the Labyrinth" and the Erinys, by month.
  - **KN Gg 702**: honey to Eileithyia.
  - **Chania Gq 5**: honey to Zeus and *di-wo-nu-so* (one of the attestations of Dionysus).
  - **PY Ep 704**: "the priestess Eritha holds and claims she holds *e-to-ni-jo* for the god, but the *damos* says she holds leased plots": a lawsuit.
  - **PY An 657**: "thus the watchers are guarding the coast", perhaps the last weeks of Pylos.
- *Bible parallels.* The **genre** of temple and palace offering lists ↔ Num 7:12–83 (gold and silver vessels, by donor), Num 28–29 (offerings by calendar), Lev 2:11 (honey banned from the altar, but here given to Poseidon), Ex 30:22–33 (perfumed anointing oil), Gen 47:22 (priests' land) and the priestess' tenure. Typological only: these are Bronze Age Aegean records with no contact with Israel. Their value is to show what a non-biblical temple economy wrote down.
- *Soul.* MEDIUM: the gods the Mycenaeans fed, their month names, the anxiety in the last tablets. The texts are terse, so the apparatus must do the work.
- *Base text and tools.*
  - **DAMOS** (`damos.hf.uio.no`, Oslo; open, constantly updated; licence not stated in the search). **Blocked here**: connection refused over HTTPS; plain HTTP answered 503.
  - LiBER (`liber.cnr.it`, Linear B Electronic Resources, CNR) is reachable (200; content not inspected).
  - Printed: PTT (Bennett & Olivier 1973–76), KT⁵/CoMIK, Ventris & Chadwick *Documents in Mycenaean Greek*² (1973; ©; the archive.org PDF upload is unauthorized, so avoid it); Aura Jorro *Diccionario Micénico* (1985–93; ©; the DGE host `dge.cchs.csic.es` answered 503); Duhoux & Morpurgo Davies (eds.), *A Companion to Linear B* (2008–14; ©).
  - Studies: Palaima on religion; Bendall 2007 *Economics of Religion in the Mycenaean World* (©).
  - **Hebrew:** none.
- *Feasibility.* Medium. Mycenaean is Greek, but the spelling is ambiguous (*pa-te* = πατέρες or πάντες) and logograms carry much of the meaning. An LLM can do it with DMic or the Companion at hand. Access is the problem.
- *Benefit*: Bible **LOW-MED** / Soul **MEDIUM**. *Recommendation*: low priority; a short dossier only once DAMOS is reachable (add `damos.hf.uio.no` to the allowlist).

2.13 Etruscan: Pyrgi, the Piacenza liver, the Tabula Capuana, the Liber Linteus

Etruscan (non-Indo-European; Tyrsenian, with Raetic and the Lemnos stele) · Pyrgi c. 500 BCE; Tabula Capuana c. 470; Liber Linteus 3rd–2nd c. BCE (a linen ritual book cut up as mummy wrappings in Egypt; Zagreb); Cippus Perusinus 3rd–2nd c.; Piacenza bronze liver c. 150–100 BCE · originals · the Liber Linteus has about 1,200 legible words in about 230 lines (the longest Etruscan text), the Tabula Capuana about 390 (about 62 lines), Pyrgi two Etruscan sheets (16 + 9 lines) and one Phoenician (11 lines), the liver about 40 god-names.

- *How well understood (rated honestly).* The phonology and much of the morphology are known: cases, the verb forms *-ce* / *-ke* (past), *-χ* (and). The secure lexicon is a few hundred words, from bilinguals, glosses and the "combinatory" method. Formulaic votive and funerary texts can be read; the long ritual texts are understood **in outline**: dates, god-names, offerings ("*vinum*" = wine; *fler* = offering; *θapna* = a vessel). Continuous translation is speculative (Belfiore 2010 and van der Meer 2007 on the Liber; Woudhuizen 2013 is disputed). **An LLM translation from Etruscan would be guesswork**; at most, render known words and leave the rest.
- *Bible parallels.*
  - The Piacenza liver: a sheep's liver model divided into 16 border regions (= the Etruscan sky) with god-names ↔ the Babylonian clay liver models (BM 92668) and the **Hazor and Megiddo clay livers**; Ezek 21:26 (*ra'a ba-kaved*). The Near Eastern origin of Etruscan haruspicy is **debated** but a classic comparison.
  - Pyrgi: Thefarie Velianas, king of Caere, dedicates a holy place to Uni = Astarte "in the month of the sacrifice to the Sun... the year three". The Phoenician side's *bym qbr 'lm* ("on the day of the burial of the deity") ↔ Ezek 8:14 Tammuz is debated. The Phoenician belongs to the Levant agent and is well understood.
- *Soul.* MEDIUM: a calendar of offerings of a vanished people; the gods of the liver.
- *Base text and tools. Etruskische Texte*² (Meiser 2014; ©); CIE; ThLE² (2009); the Etruscan Texts Project (UMass; **unreachable**); Mnamon (SNS Pisa; unreachable); a Zenodo concordance of Etruscan/Faliscan/early Latin corpora (2025, zenodo.org/records/17209666, page 200, reported). Christian Lehmann's annotated Pyrgi page (verified 200). Bellelli & Xella (eds.) 2016 *Le lamine di Pyrgi* (SEL 32–33). Grammars: Bonfante & Bonfante 2002, Wallace 2008 *Zikh Rasna* (©). **Hebrew:** none.
- *Benefit*: Bible **LOW-MED** / Soul **MEDIUM**. *Recommendation*: only a short hedged dossier, Pyrgi (both languages) plus the liver, with known words glossed and no "translation" of the Liber Linteus. Not a priority.

2.14 Herodotus, Book 2 (and parts of 1) – reception

Ionic prose · c. 440–425 BCE · papyri; medieval mss (10th c.+) · Book 2 = 182 chapters · complete.

- *What it is.* Egypt as seen by a Greek: the Nile, the priests' 341 generations, animal cults, Psammetichus' language experiment (2.2), the Trojan War "really" in Egypt (2.112–120). Book 1 covers Babylon (1.178–200), including the "sacred marriage" and temple prostitution (1.199).
- *Bible relevance (as reception and external witness).* 2.104: the Colchians, Egyptians and Ethiopians circumcise, and "the Phoenicians and the Syrians of Palestine admit they learned it from the Egyptians" ↔ Gen 17, Josh 5:2–9. 2.159: Necho defeats "the Syrians" at Magdolos (= Megiddo, 2 Kgs 23:29). 2.141: Sennacherib's army and the mice ↔ 2 Kgs 19:35. Medium value; mostly not "very old tradition".
- *Base.* Perseus (Godley, CC BY-SA 4.0 in the file, verified); treebank of Book 1 (verified). **Hebrew:** Alexander Schorr (Reuven Mass, 1935–36; reported to be on Ben-Yehuda), and Shimron & Zelnick-Abramovitz (Papyrus/Dyonon 1998; Carmel 2013) (reported).
- *Benefit*: Bible **MEDIUM** / Soul **MEDIUM**. *Recommendation*: do not translate; cite in the apparatus of other projects.

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3. Also considered

- **Aeschylus** (*Suppliants* c. 463, *Oresteia* 458, *Persians* 472, *Prometheus Bound* (authorship debated)). These fall within the 450 BCE line. The Eumenides' homicide court ↔ Num 35; Prometheus ↔ Gen 3 and 11. They are already translated into Hebrew by Shabtai (Schocken 1990–2011) and are dramatic literature rather than a record of tradition. Not now.
- **Pindar** (518–438; *Olympian* 2, the Isles of the Blest; fr. 129–133 on the afterlife; *Ol.* 9.41–56, Deucalion's flood) and **Bacchylides** (Croesus on the pyre, 3; Meleager in Hades, 5): excerpts for the apparatus only.
- **Aristophanes, *Birds* 685–702** (414 BCE): Night lays a wind-egg in Erebos, Eros hatches, and the birds are older than the gods. It is an Orphic cosmogony in comic form, and a nice footnote for the fifth day (birds). Excerpt only.
- **Plato's androgyne** (*Symposium* 189–193) ↔ Gen 2:21–24 (Gen. Rabbah 8:1 *androgynos*). Late (c. 385 BCE) and a literary invention; cite only. **Gmirkin's thesis** (Gen 1–11 dependent on Plato and Berossus) is **largely rejected**; record only.
- **Philo of Byblos / Sanchuniathon** (Phoenician cosmogony in Greek, via Eusebius) → Levant survey. **Kumarbi cycle** → Anatolia survey.
- **Epic Cycle** apart from Cypria fr. 1 (Proclus' summaries; fragments): too thin.
- **Hippocratic *On the Sacred Disease*** (c. 400; a critique of purifiers ↔ Lev 13): later and medical; cite only.
- **Delphic oracles** in Herodotus (hexameter oracles of the 6th c.) ↔ biblical prophecy: authenticity often doubtful.
- **Aesop** (6th c. tradition; collections are much later) ↔ Ahiqar and Judg 9: late witnesses.
- **The Palaikastro Hymn of the Kouretes** (inscription 3rd c. CE, text 4th–3rd c. BCE; Zeus' birth in Crete): short; possible add-on to the Hymns.
- **Cypriot syllabic Greek: the Idalion bronze** (ICS 217, c. 480–470 BCE): a contract of king Stasikypros with the physician Onasilos ↔ Ex 21:18–19 (healing costs). Short and interesting; candidate for the law corpus (verify the text source).
- **Greek Magical Papyri (PGM)**: 2nd–5th c. CE; late; with Jewish elements (Iao Sabaoth). Excluded as too late for this region.
- **Sibylline Oracles**: Jewish and Christian, late. Excluded.
- **Linear A, Cretan hieroglyphic, Cypro-Minoan, the Phaistos disc**: undeciphered. Excluded. Cyrus Gordon's "Semitic Linear A" is **rejected**.
- **Eteocretan, Eteocypriot, the Lemnos stele**: the language is not understood (Lemnian is Etruscan-related). Excluded.
- **Oscan** (Tabula Bantina c. 100 BCE, municipal law; Cippus Abellanus, a treaty; the **Agnone tablet** c. 250 BCE, a list of gods and altars in a grove of Ceres; Oscan curse tablets): better understood than Umbrian, but smaller. The Agnone tablet could join the Iguvine project.
- **South Picene, Faliscan, Venetic, Messapic**: short, poorly understood. Excluded.

- **Old Latin literary fragments** (Livius Andronicus' *Odusia*, Naevius, Ennius' *Annales*): 3rd–2nd c. BCE, Greek-derived literature, fragmentary. Not now.
- **Praeneste fibula** ("Manios med fhefhaked Numasioi"): authenticity long debated (now generally accepted, verify). A single line; mention in the Old Latin corpus.
- **Iberian** (Levantine and Southern scripts; lead plaques): the script is read but the language is not understood. **Excluded.** The Hesperia database (`hesperia.ucm.es`) answers over plain HTTP only (HTTPS refused).
- **Celtiberian** (Botorrita I, about 200 words, c. 100 BCE, perhaps regulations of a sacred precinct): partly understood. Too thin. **Tartessian/Southwest script**: Koch's Celtic decipherment is **disputed**. **Lusitanian** (Cabeço das Fráguas: a sheep, a pig and a bull to local gods, a suovetaurilia-like rite ↔ Lev; Lamas de Moledo): 1st c. CE, Latin script, very short; a curiosity only. **Gaulish** (Larzac, Chamalières, Coligny calendar) → Celtic survey.
- **Forgeries and false leads:** the **"Brothers" and "Kypris" Sappho poems** (published 2014) are genuine-looking texts with a **tainted provenance** (the Obbink/Green Collection affair). Use with an explicit warning, or not at all. The **Ventris–Chadwick PDF** and other Loeb PDFs on archive.org are unauthorized uploads: do not use them. "Etruscan decoded" books from outside academia (e.g., Basque, Hebrew or Hungarian "solutions") are pseudo-scholarship: ignore them.

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4. Access notes (all tested today, 2026-10-21, from this session; HTTP code from `curl -s -o /dev/null -m 20 -w "%{http_code}"`)

Works (200, with content checked where noted)

- `raw.githubusercontent.com` (PerseusDL `canonical-greekLit`, `canonical-latinLit`, `treebank_data`, `lexica`; OGL `First1KGreek`). Content verified: Hesiod and Homer XML, the Theogony treebank, the LSJ and Lewis & Short XML (HTTP 206 range fetch).
- **Treeless** `git clone --depth 1 --filter=blob:none --no-checkout https://github.com/<org>/<repo>.git` works through the proxy and allows `git ls-tree` and `git show`. Used today to list `canonical-greekLit` (2,541 XML), `First1KGreek` (1,022 Greek files) and `treebank_data`.
- `scaife.perseus.org` (reader 200; the CTS API at `scaife-cts.perseus.org` returned an empty body).
- `www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/` front page 200, **but dynamic pages (`/hopper/morph`, `/hopper/text?doc=...`) answer 405 "Not allowed" (Varnish).** Use GitHub raw instead.
- `anastrophe.uchicago.edu/logeion-api/detail?w=<word>&type=normal` returns LSJ JSON (verified with χάος); `logeion.uchicago.edu` 200.
- `www.thelatinlibrary.com` (Twelve Tables, Carmen Arvale, Cato: verified); `penelope.uchicago.edu` (LacusCurtius Cato: verified); `www.forumromanum.org` 200.
- `benyehuda.org` (Tchernichovsky's Iliad `/read/5526`, Odyssey `/read/5592`, verified; author page `/author/57`).
- `igcyr.unibo.it` (EpiDoc XML, CC BY-NC 4.0: verified); `www.attalus.org` (SEG 9.72 page verified); `edh.ub.uni-heidelberg.de` 200; `papyri.info` 200.
- `www-current.chs.harvard.edu` (Derveni project page verified); `chs.harvard.edu` (Tzifopoulos book page 200).
- `archive.org`: the advancedsearch and metadata APIs work; `download/..._djvu.txt` with `-L` works (Kern 1922, Buck 1904 fetched). One redirect target, `ia800300.us.archive.org`, failed; another, `ia802805`, worked.
- `www.homermultitext.org`, `bmcr.brynmawr.edu`, `www.jstor.org`, `www.persee.fr`, `brill.com`, `library.oapen.org`, `journals.openedition.org`, `www.gutenberg.org`, `www.theoi.com`, `www.loebclassics.com` (paywalled content), `stephanus.tlg.uci.edu` (TLG: paid, record only), `liber.cnr.it`, `www.palaeolexicon.com`, `sourcebooks.web.fordham.edu`, `amesfoundation.law.harvard.edu`, `www.christianlehmann.eu`, `zenodo.org`, `dcc.dickinson.edu`, `www.ledonline.it`, `edizionicafoscari.unive.it`, `www.iliesi.cnr.it`.
- `hesperia.ucm.es`: **plain HTTP 200**, HTTPS refused.

Blocked or failing

- `github.com` web and `api.github.com` (403: "GitHub access to this repository is not enabled for this session"); `gh api` the same. Use raw or `git clone`.
- **`damos.hf.uio.no`**: HTTPS connection refused; HTTP 503. **`cgrn.ulg.ac.be` / `cgrn.uliege.be`**: connection refused.
- **`inscriptions.packhum.org`, `epigraphy.packhum.org`, `latin.packhum.org`: 403.**
- `lsj.gr`, `lsj.translatum.gr`: 403. `www.academia.edu`, `www.cambridge.org`, `academic.oup.com`, `www.hathitrust.org` and `babel.hathitrust.org`, `gallica.bnf.fr`, `www.poetryintranslation.com`, `www.oeaw.ac.at`, `www.biblicalstudies.org.uk`: 403.
- Connection refused (000): `homer.library.northwestern.edu` (Chicago Homer), `www.etp.classics.umass.edu` (Etruscan Texts Project), `www.mnamon.sns.it`, `www.trismegistos.org`, `diorisis.ac.uk`, `www.thesaurus-linguae-etruscae.de`, `etruskisch.de`, `db.edcs.eu`, `www.stoa.org`, `homer.chs.harvard.edu`, `kosmos-society.org`, `www.iguvine.org`, the GRBS PKP file host.
- `dge.cchs.csic.es` (DGE / Diccionario Micénico): 503.
- `el.wikisource.org`, `he.wikisource.org`, `he.wikipedia.org`: pages load (200 after a 301), but the **MediaWiki API answered with an error page or 429** (rate-limited) to scripted calls. WebFetch worked for single pages.

Hosts a future session needs in its allowlist (beyond the current `domains.txt`):

- `raw.githubusercontent.com` (and `github.com` for git clone);
- `anastrophe.uchicago.edu`, `logeion.uchicago.edu`, `scaife.perseus.org`, `www.perseus.tufts.edu`;
- `www.thelatinlibrary.com`, `penelope.uchicago.edu`, `benyehuda.org`, `igcyr.unibo.it`, `www.attalus.org`;
- `www-current.chs.harvard.edu`, `chs.harvard.edu`;
- to unblock if the user can: `damos.hf.uio.no`, `cgrn.uliege.be`, `inscriptions.packhum.org`.

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5. Sources consulted

Data endpoints (fetched)

- Perseus repos via `https://raw.githubusercontent.com/PerseusDL/canonical-greekLit/master/` (README licence; Hesiod `data/tlg0020/...`; Homer `data/tlg0012/...`; Hymns `data/tlg0013/...`; Herodotus `data/tlg0016/...`).
- Treebank: `https://raw.githubusercontent.com/PerseusDL/treebank_data/master/v2.1/Greek/texts/tlg0020.tlg001.perseus-grc1.tb.xml`. Lexica: `https://raw.githubusercontent.com/PerseusDL/lexica/master/CTS_XML_TEI/perseus/pdllex/grc/lsj/grc.lsj.perseus-eng1.xml`.
- First1KGreek Orphica: `https://github.com/OpenGreekAndLatin/First1KGreek` → `data/tlg0579/tlg010/tlg0579.tlg010.1st1K-grc1.xml`.
- Logeion API: `https://anastrophe.uchicago.edu/logeion-api/detail?w=χάος&type=normal`.
- Ben-Yehuda: https://benyehuda.org/read/5526, https://benyehuda.org/read/5592, https://benyehuda.org/author/57.
- IGCyr: https://igcyr.unibo.it/igcyr/igcyr016700.xml. Attalus: https://www.attalus.org/docs/seg/s09_72.html.
- Latin: https://www.thelatinlibrary.com/12tables.html, https://www.thelatinlibrary.com/carmenarvale.html, https://www.thelatinlibrary.com/cato/cato.agri.html, https://penelope.uchicago.edu/Thayer/E/Roman/Texts/Cato/De_Agricultura/home.html.
- archive.org metadata and texts: https://archive.org/metadata/bronzetablesofig00poul, https://archive.org/download/grammarofoscanum00buckuoft/grammarofoscanum00buckuoft_djvu.txt, https://archive.org/download/orphicorumfragme00orphuoft/orphicorumfragme00orphuoft_djvu.txt, plus the advancedsearch queries for Buck, Poultney, Kern, Diels, Lyra Graeca, Cunliffe, Gortyn and Bréal.
- CHS Derveni: https://www-current.chs.harvard.edu/publications-projects-derveni/. Roby's Gortyn: https://amesfoundation.law.harvard.edu/RL/mats/GortynCode_Roby.pdf.
- Hebrew Wikisource, Odyssey: https://he.wikisource.org/wiki/אודיסיאה_(הומרוס). Magnes, Iliad: https://www.magnespress.co.il/book/2752-איליאדה. Hebrew Wikipedia, Aharon Shabtai: https://he.wikipedia.org/wiki/אהרן_שבתאי.

Search results relied on (reported)

- Hesiod in Hebrew: https://simania.co.il/bookdetails.php?item_id=265495, https://simania.co.il/bookdetails.php?item_id=43860, https://www.booksefer.co.il/index.php?cs=42691&dir=site&langpage=heb&op=item&page=catalog, https://he.wikipedia.org/wiki/תאוגוניה.
- Homeric Hymns in Hebrew (Spann 1946): https://catalog.princeton.edu/catalog/SCSB-3154577.
- Sappho and lyric in Hebrew: https://www.ynet.co.il/articles/0,7340,L-3801848,00.html, https://liebes.huji.ac.il/files/marmatok.pdf, https://elihirsh.com/, https://www.sipurpashut.com/products/שירת-יוון-העתיקה.
- Homer in Hebrew: https://classicsmalta.org/iliad-translations/, https://www.israelhayom.co.il/article/376769 (blocked, 403; snippet only).
- Herodotus in Hebrew: https://herodotushelpline.org/what-is-the-history-of-translation-of-herodotus-in-hebrew/.
- DAMOS: https://damos.hf.uio.no/about/database/, https://wiki.digitalclassicist.org/DAMOS_Database_of_Mycenaean_at_Oslo.
- Derveni: https://bmcr.brynmawr.edu/2006/2006.10.29, https://en.olschki.it/libro/9788822255679, https://classicalstudies.org/reconsidering-allegoresis-and-poetics-derveni-papyrus.
- CGRN: https://currentepigraphy.org/2017/09/03/collection-of-greek-ritual-norms-cgrn/, https://edizionicafoscari.unive.it/it/edizioni4/riviste/axon/2019/2/two-notes-on-the-collection-of-greek-ritual-norms/.
- Gortyn: https://sourcebooks.web.fordham.edu/ancient/450-gortyn.asp, https://grbs.library.duke.edu/article/viewFile/6271/5147, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gortyn_code.
- Selinous: https://riviste.unimi.it/index.php/Dike/article/view/3494, https://www.iliesi.cnr.it/pandemia/testi/ROBERT%20PARKER%20Miasma%20Pollution%20and%20Purification%20in%20Early%20Greek%20R (Parker, *Miasma*; status of this copy unclear, not used).
- Orphic tablets: https://www-current.chs.harvard.edu/?p=170799, https://bmcr.brynmawr.edu/2015/2015.06.18/.
- Hesiod and the Near East: https://classicsforall.org.uk/reading-room/book-reviews/hesiod-theogony (Clay & Vergados 2025), https://classicsforall.org.uk/reading-room/book-reviews/greek-mythology-creation-first-humans (López-Ruiz 2025), https://grbs.library.duke.edu/index.php/grbs/article/download/12791/1881/0.
- Louden: https://www.routledge.com/Greek-Myth-and-the-Bible/Louden/p/book/9780367664749, https://bmcr.brynmawr.edu/?p=44172.
- Etruscan: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Liber_Linteus, https://bmcr.brynmawr.edu/?p=30724, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pyrgi_Tablets, https://www.christianlehmann.eu/ling/sprachen/languages_antiquity/etruscan/pyrgi_1.html, https://wiki.digitalclassicist.org/Etruscan_Texts_Project, https://zenodo.org/records/17209666.
- Iguvine: https://www.attalus.org/docs/iguvium.html, https://britannica.com/topic/Iguvine-Tables, https://www-current.chs.harvard.edu/curated-article/gregory-nagy-the-fire-ritual-of-the-iguvine-tables-facing-a-central-problem-in-the-study-of-ritual-language.
- Linear B religion: https://classical-inquiries.chs.harvard.edu/annotation/about-what-kinds-of-things-we-may-learn-about-mythology-by-reading-about-rituals-recorded-by-bureaucratic-scribes-2/, https://publicera.kb.se/opuscula/article/download/62703/50463/159535.

Scratch downloads of this survey (untrusted data, not in the repo): `/tmp/claude-0/-home-user-perush/009325a3-391a-55eb-9c0e-32e1e254e6c6/scratchpad/world/greek-aegean-italic/`.